
Aristea

Class advancement and prestige-class analysis, levels 17-35

Twenty-one prestige classes ranked and analyzed

Prepared from the current character record, campaign rulings, and verified Pathfinder prestige-class text. Conditional epic options are separated from printed-rule fallbacks.

Executive recommendation

Aristea should complete the printed Arcane Trickster class first. Her current build is Exploiter Wizard 9 / Crossblooded Wildblooded Sorcerer 1 / Arcane Trickster 7. Levels 18-20 should be Arcane Trickster 8-10. That preserves full Wizard casting, adds sneak attack, and reaches Surprise Spells, the feature that lets damaging spells apply sneak attack beyond the normal attack-roll restrictions.

At level 20 she should be an effective nineteenth-level Wizard caster with the printed Arcane Trickster capstone and, under the current artifact ruling, approximately +13d6 total sneak attack before temporary effects. Her artifact contributes +5d6, and the campaign ruling allows qualifying rays to deliver sneak attack. Benthic Spell, Merciful Spell, Sap Adept, and Sap Master remain a powerful damage package, but Sap Master requires a genuinely flat-footed target unless the GM has ruled otherwise.

Arcane Trickster itself cannot be taken beyond class level 10. The campaign does, however, allow **Evangelist's aligned class to extend Arcane Trickster after its printed capstone**. Aristea should therefore take Evangelist 1-10 at character levels 21-30 and select Arcane Trickster as the aligned class. Evangelist 2-10 advances her as Arcane Trickster 11-19, including full arcane casting and the continued sneak-attack pattern. She then returns to Exploiter Wizard for levels 31-35.

The recommended level-35 build is **Exploiter Wizard 14 / Crossblooded Wildblooded Sorcerer 1 / Arcane Trickster 10 / Evangelist 10**. It reaches effective Wizard casting 33 and effective Arcane Trickster progression 19. The two missing caster levels are Sorcerer 1 and Evangelist 1. Post-20 spell progression is confirmed; these effective casting levels continue the campaign's epic spell progression rather than only increasing spell variables.

Confirmed rulings and remaining decision gates

Confirmed: Arcane Trickster ends at class level 10. Evangelist may select Arcane Trickster as its aligned class and extend its progression through effective Arcane Trickster level 19. Spell progression continues after level 20. Existing class-level features continue scaling, but no new named abilities or repeated capstones appear beyond a printed class table. Deity-specific prestige classes such as Stargazer are legal through patron adaptation.

1. What is the campaign's exact post-20 Wizard spell-slot progression?
2. Does Sap Master double the artifact's +5d6 sneak attack, and is the doubling limited to dice eligible under the flat-footed requirement?
3. Does Surprise Spells apply once per spell, once per attack roll, or to every ray under the campaign's existing multi-ray sneak-attack ruling?
4. Which Nereus adaptation is used for patron-specific prestige features?

The guide models the published even-level sneak-attack pattern continuing through effective Arcane Trickster 19. That adds +4d6 after Arcane Trickster 10, for approximately +17d6 total sneak attack including the artifact. The artifact's +5d6, narwhal Animal Lord form, and existing campaign ray ruling remain in force.

Recommended level-by-level path

Level	Class	Effective Wizard casting	Main gain	Why now
18	Arcane Trickster 8	17	Ninth-level spells and sneak attack +1d6	Delivers her largest spell-access breakpoint while scaling the artifact-supported ray engine.
19	Arcane Trickster 9	18	Impromptu sneak attack improvement	Full casting and better access to sneak conditions.
20	Arcane Trickster 10	19	Surprise Spells, sneak attack +1d6	The printed capstone is the build's defining breakpoint.
21	Evangelist 1	19	Protective grace and prestige entry	Pays the route's only additional lost caster level after Surprise Spells is secured.
22	Evangelist 2	20	Aligned Arcane Trickster 11	Arcane Trickster progression resumes through aligned class.
23	Evangelist 3	21	Aligned Arcane Trickster 12, sneak attack +1d6, first boon	Combines damage progression, casting, and Nereus devotion.
24	Evangelist 4	22	Aligned Arcane Trickster 13	Continues full arcane casting and extended trickster features.
25	Evangelist 5	23	Aligned Arcane Trickster 14, sneak attack +1d6	Raises total sneak attack to approximately +15d6 including the artifact.
26	Evangelist 6	24	Aligned Arcane Trickster 15, second boon	Reaches the most important middle obedience breakpoint.
27	Evangelist 7	25	Aligned Arcane Trickster 16, sneak attack +1d6	Continues the ray-striker engine.
28	Evangelist 8	26	Aligned Arcane Trickster 17	Preserves casting while adding Evangelist utility.
29	Evangelist 9	27	Aligned Arcane Trickster 18, sneak attack +1d6, third boon	Reaches approximately +17d6 total sneak attack including the artifact.
30	Evangelist 10	28	Aligned Arcane Trickster 19, spiritual form	Completes the Evangelist block and extended Arcane Trickster progression.
31	Exploiter Wizard 10	29	Wizard bonus feat and reservoir progression	Returns to the base class after aligned-class advancement is complete.
32	Exploiter Wizard 11	30	Arcane reservoir scaling	More fuel for Potent Magic, dimensional slide, and counterplay.
33	Exploiter Wizard 12	31	Exploit progression	Adds a new customizable arcane tool.
34	Exploiter Wizard 13	32	Wizard progression	Maintains full spell advancement.
35	Exploiter Wizard 14	33	Exploit progression	Ends with effective casting 33 and Arcane Trickster progression 19.

Ranked prestige-class summary

Rank	Grade	Prestige class	Casting progression	Verdict
1	S+	Arcane Trickster	10/10	Complete levels 8-10 immediately to secure ninth-level spells and Surprise Spells.
2	S+	Evangelist	9/10 plus aligned class	Confirmed to extend Arcane Trickster to effective level 19; this is the definitive post-20 route.
3	S-	Stargazer	10/10	Patron adaptation makes its familiar, hexes, star-domain tools, and full casting legally available.
4	A+	Magaambyan Arcanist	10/10	Adds selected druid spells to Wizard casting and preserves every caster level.
5	A	Loremaster	10/10	Full casting and flexible secrets with achievable prerequisites.
6	A-	Cyphermage	10/10	Full casting plus superior scroll and glyph use; narrower than more spell-list expansion.
7	B+	Harrower	10/10	Full casting and fate tools, but requires feats, skills, and a card subsystem.
8	B+	Veiled Illusionist	10/10	Strong infiltration and defense without caster loss; less direct damage synergy.
9	B	Pathfinder Savant	6/7	Excellent off-list spell access, but its single lost caster level matters.
10	B-	Bloatmage	10/10	Real spell-slot power at the cost of severe safety, body, and role concerns.
11	C+	Enchanting Courtesan	9/10	Useful covert magic, but wrong specialty and a lost caster level.
12	C	Mortal Usher	5/10 class advancement	Reaping damage is attractive, but half advancement is too costly for a primary caster.
13	C-	Eldritch Knight	9/10	Full base attack does not advance Aristeia's core ray-and-spell strategy.
14	D+	Dragon Disciple	7/10	Likely ineligible without a draconic bloodline and redundant with superior shapechanging.
15	D	Arcane Archer	7/10	Feat-heavy bow mechanics and three lost caster levels fight the actual build.
16	D	Sleepless Detective	None	Intelligence and sneak attack are appealing, but ten lost caster levels are unacceptable.
17	D-	Master Spy	None	Strong disguise narrative, weak advancement for an epic Wizard.
18	F	Mystic Theurge	10/10 both classes	Aristeia lacks second-level divine casting; buying it would delay her real spell engine.
19	F	Hellknight Signifer	10/10	Full casting cannot fix alignment, armor, initiation, and story incompatibility.
20	F	Genie Binder	3/5	Aristeia is good-aligned, and two lost levels in five are too expensive.
21	F	Sentinel	None	Martial devotion offers nothing worth sacrificing epic arcane casting.

In-depth prestige-class analysis

Arcane Trickster - S+

Arcane Trickster is already the correct prestige class for Aristeia. Its full casting, sneak attack progression, impromptu sneak attack, ranged legerdemain, and Surprise Spells connect her Wizard chassis to the artifact's +5d6 sneak attack. Levels 8 and 10 add sneak attack, while level 10 unlocks the capstone that makes damaging spells eligible for sneak attack against flat-footed targets. No other printed prestige class improves the current concept as directly.

The printed table ends at level 10, so Aristeia cannot take an eleventh Arcane Trickster level directly. The campaign instead allows Evangelist's aligned class to extend Arcane Trickster. This distinction matters: levels 21-30 are Evangelist levels, with Evangelist 2-10 producing effective Arcane Trickster levels 11-19. The printed capstone is not taken again.

Qualification already satisfied: sneak attack +2d6, Disable Device 4, Escape Artist 4, Knowledge (arcana) 4, third-level arcane spells, mage hand. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 376.

Evangelist - S+

Evangelist is the definitive post-20 class because the campaign permits aligned class to select and extend Arcane Trickster beyond its printed tenth level. Evangelist 1 is a genuine cost: it advances neither casting nor Arcane Trickster. Evangelist 2-10 then advances the Arcane Trickster chassis nine times while adding obedience boons, skill utility, languages, and spiritual form.

Using the continued even-level sneak-attack pattern, effective Arcane Trickster levels 12, 14, 16, and 18 each add +1d6. Aristeia therefore rises from approximately +13d6 at character level 20 to +17d6 at character level 29, including the artifact. Effective Wizard casting reaches 28 at character level 30. The remaining question is which non-sneak-attack features, if any, scale beyond Arcane Trickster 10; the guide does not assume a second Surprise Spells capstone.

Qualification: compatible deity worship, Deific Obedience, and the listed spell or skill route. Arcane Trickster is the confirmed aligned class. **Source:** *Inner Sea Gods*, p. 198.

Stargazer - S-

Stargazer provides full casting, a familiar, access to witch hexes, the Stars subdomain, Coat of Many Stars, and additional stellar defenses and utility. Those tools are excellent for a high-Intelligence Wizard who values flexible action economy, scouting, protective magic, and non-spell resources. Confirmed post-20 spell progression means all ten caster levels continue Aristeia's epic Wizard magic.

The printed Pulura requirement is not a barrier under the campaign's patron-adaptation rule. Its domain and religious references can be translated into a Nereus-appropriate stars, navigation, sea, or weather package. Stargazer ranks below Evangelist because it does not continue Arcane Trickster sneak attack, but it is the strongest alternative full-casting prestige class if Aristeia wants breadth instead of maximum ray damage.

Qualification: the Pulura patron requirement is adapted to Nereus; the printed alignment and third-level spell requirements otherwise remain unless separately changed. **Source:** *Paths of the Righteous*, p. 30.

Magaambyan Arcanist - A+

Magaambyan Arcanist advances arcane casting at every level and gradually adds druid spells to the Wizard list. For Aristeia, this is more than generic versatility: water, weather, animal, plant, healing, and transformation magic reinforce her Nereus devotion and Animal Lord identity. It can add divine-style support without taking a divine-caster dip or sacrificing caster level.

The opportunity cost is Exploiter Wizard advancement. Prestige levels do not normally increase arcane reservoir or grant new exploits and Wizard bonus feats. The class is strongest after Arcane Trickster 10 when a specific druid spell package is worth more than those class features. Its good-alignment requirement fits Aristeia.

Qualification: good alignment, Scholar and Spell Mastery, Knowledge (arcana) 5, Knowledge (nature) 5, Spellcraft 5, and prepared third-level arcane spells. **Source:** *Adventurer's Guide*, p. 118.

Loremaster - A

Loremaster provides ten levels of full casting and five selectable secrets. It is an excellent printed-rule bridge when epic base-class or prestige tables are uncertain. Aristeia can use secrets to acquire feats, improve saving throws, or cover a prerequisite while retaining every Wizard caster level. The lore theme also fits an ancient-sea scholar, merchant-mage, and relic hunter.

The class requires a large feat package and seven divinations. Its lore checks favor Intelligence, which is good for Aristeia, but they do not increase sneak attack, reservoir, or exploits. Loremaster is the safest prestige choice, not the most aggressive one.

Qualification: two Knowledge skills at 7 ranks, three metamagic or item-creation feats, Skill Focus in a Knowledge skill, third-level spells, and seven divinations including one of third level or higher. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 385.

Cyphermage - A-

Cyphermage advances casting at every level and offers a cypher lore on most levels. Its scroll, glyph, rune, and written-magic abilities suit a Wizard with extensive crafting access and broad spell knowledge. Aristeia can turn downtime wealth into flexible prepared answers and preserve rare spells outside her daily slots.

It ranks below Magaambyan Arcanist because its best tricks often require scroll actions and consumable preparation rather than improving her immediate ray offense. Cypher Magic and language prerequisites also consume resources. It is excellent in exploration and artifact play, merely good in a direct boss fight.

Qualification: Cypher Magic, Scribe Scroll, two additional languages, Knowledge (arcana) 5, Knowledge (history) 5, Linguistics 5, and arcane spellcasting. **Source:** *Adventurer's Guide*, p. 57.

Harrower - B+

Harrower preserves full casting and overlays fate-based card effects on spell use. Aristeia's high Intelligence and tactical patience make her well suited to extracting value from a flexible subsystem. The setting's prophecies and divine manipulation also make Harrow magic narratively appropriate.

It does not add sneak attack, exploits, or new spell-list access, and the Harrowed feat plus Perform and deck requirements are real costs. Random or semi-random bonuses can be less dependable than Potent Magic or a planned metamagic sequence. It is a strong flavorful path when fate is central to the campaign.

Qualification: non-true-neutral alignment, Harrowed, relevant skills at 5 ranks, third-level spells, three divinations, and a Harrow deck. **Source:** *The Inner Sea World Guide*, p. 276.

Veiled Illusionist - B+

Veiled Illusionist gives full casting and develops disguise, glamor, and veil magic. Illusions can create the concealment, misinformation, and positioning that allow Aristeia to begin encounters on favorable terms. They also provide defenses that do not rely on armor or hit points.

The class does not improve her artifact-supported sneak dice, metamagic damage, reservoir, or water-and-cold identity. It is best for a campaign dominated by infiltration and intelligence work. Alley is already a dedicated spymaster on Maarin's crew, so Aristeia may not need to spend class levels duplicating that specialty.

Qualification: Spell Focus (illusion), Bluff 5, Disguise 5, Knowledge (arcana) 2, and three illusion spells including one of second level or higher. **Source:** *Paths of Prestige*, p. 60.

Pathfinder Savant - B

Pathfinder Savant adds off-list spells and item mastery. For a Wizard, the ability to select key divine or occult answers can be build-defining. It is especially attractive if Magaambyan Arcanist's feat or organizational assumptions do not fit the campaign.

The class advances casting on only six of seven levels. Aristeia is already one effective Wizard caster level behind because of Sorcerer 1, so another loss delays or weakens every level-dependent spell benefit. Take it only when the chosen off-list spells are concrete, repeatedly useful, and unavailable through party cooperation or items.

Qualification: Magical Aptitude, an item-creation feat, Knowledge (arcana) 5, Spellcraft 5, Use Magic Device 5, and second-level spells. **Source:** *Adventurer's Guide*, p. 140.

Bloatmage - B-

Bloatmage keeps full arcane casting and uses a blood pool to recover or enhance spell resources. In pure numerical terms, additional high-level spell access is powerful. A well-managed pool can extend adventuring endurance beyond what a normal Wizard expects.

The failure state is severe: exceeding safe limits risks loss of control, violence, or death. The physical transformation and blood-centered identity also conflict with Aristeia's controlled, elegant water, cold, and shapeshifting themes. Her role already rewards careful precision; adding a lethal resource-management hazard is unnecessary unless the player actively wants that story.

Qualification: Bloatmage Initiate, Spell Focus, and third-level arcane spells. **Source:** *City of Strangers*, p. 60.

Enchanting Courtesan - C+

Enchanting Courtesan advances casting on nine levels and improves discreet divination and enchantment. Covert casting can be valuable in negotiations, and touch delivery creates unusual tactical options.

Aristea is not an enchantment specialist. Tulip's trauma from Nyssa and domination also makes heavy enchantment use socially fraught within the crew. More importantly, the class loses a caster level while doing little for rays, sneak attack, water, cold, or shapechanging. It is mechanically usable but strategically off-center.

Qualification: Spell Focus in divination and enchantment, relevant social and magical skills, and qualifying spells. **Source:** *Inner Sea Intrigue*, p. 34.

Mortal Usher - C

Mortal Usher adds reaping-strike damage and psychopomp powers while advancing a prior class on five of ten levels. Extra precision-like dice appear appealing beside Aristeia's sneak attack. The class also resonates with her death at Tradegulf and the possibility of returning from Tartarus.

The damage does not compensate for five missing caster levels. Aristeia's spells scale offense, defense, mobility, dispelling, and utility simultaneously. Reaping strike is limited and does not automatically interact with Sap Master or the artifact's sneak dice. Choose it only for a major resurrection or psychopomp story.

Qualification: neutral alignment, Knowledge (planes) 6, Knowledge (religion) 6, and a qualifying psychopomp event. **Source:** *Pathfinder Adventure Path #144*, p. 76.

Eldritch Knight - C-

Eldritch Knight has full base attack, martial weapon access, nine of ten caster levels, bonus combat feats, and Spell Critical at level 10. It can turn an arcane caster into a credible weapon combatant.

Aristea's attack spells already target touch AC and deliver far more damage through sneak attack than a conventional weapon routine. Martial proficiency and base attack do not improve her caster-level checks, spell DCs, reservoir, or Animal Lord magic. Losing one caster level for a role she does not need is a poor trade.

Qualification: proficiency with all martial weapons and third-level arcane spells. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 384.

Dragon Disciple - D+

Dragon Disciple grants ability increases, natural armor, claws, breath, wings, and dragon form while advancing only seven caster levels. Aristeia has a Sorcerer level, so the class superficially appears accessible.

Sorcerers must have a draconic bloodline to qualify, and her Crossblooded Wildblooded selection is not documented as draconic. Even if legal, she already possesses superior Wizard polymorph options and the sacred narwhal form. Three lost caster levels and Strength-focused rewards are contrary to her build.

Qualification: non-dragon type, Knowledge (arcana) 5, Draconic language, spontaneous first-level arcane spells, and a draconic bloodline for Sorcerers. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 380.

Arcane Archer - D

Arcane Archer offers enchanted arrows, imbued spells, and archery capstones. As a half-elf, Aristeia satisfies the ancestry requirement, and ranged combat is part of her tactical identity.

Her ranged weapon is a spell ray, not a bow. Entry requires base attack +6 and several archery feats, while the class loses casting on three levels. Imbue arrow cannot compete with her existing ability to deliver sneak attack through high-level spells. This class would rebuild the character around an inferior delivery system.

Qualification: elf or half-elf, base attack +6, Point-Blank Shot, Precise Shot, Weapon Focus with a bow, and first-level arcane spells. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 374.

Sleepless Detective - D

Sleepless Detective adds Intelligence to Perception and Sense Motive, investigation abilities, and up to +4d6 sneak attack. Those features align with Aristeia's Intelligence and could increase her precision-damage pool.

It grants no spellcasting. Ten levels would cost ten effective Wizard levels to gain fewer sneak dice than her artifact already supplies. Skills and investigation can be handled by spells, allies, and small dips far more cheaply. It is useful NPC design and a poor epic-PC progression.

Qualification: Alertness and a substantial investigation-skill package. **Source:** *Paths of Prestige*, p. 52.

Master Spy - D-

Master Spy provides deep-cover identities, disguise defenses, mental protections, and +4d6 sneak attack over ten levels. It can support an espionage campaign.

Like Sleepless Detective, it grants no casting. Aristeia would abandon the resource that makes every aspect of her build work. Maarin already employs Alley as spymaster, so this also duplicates an established crew role.

Qualification: Deceitful, Iron Will, and high Bluff, Disguise, and Sense Motive. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Advanced Player's Guide*, p. 270.

Mystic Theurge - F

Mystic Theurge advances an arcane and divine class simultaneously. It is valuable only when the character already owns meaningful spellcasting on both tracks.

Aristeia has no second-level divine casting. Acquiring it would require several levels or unusual qualification tricks, delaying Arcane Trickster 10 and weakening Wizard progression. Magaambyan Arcanist gives her selected druid spells without buying a second weak casting class, making it the superior route for divine-style breadth.

Qualification: second-level arcane and second-level divine spells. **Source:** *Pathfinder RPG Core Rulebook*, p. 387.

Hellknight Signifer - F

Hellknight Signifer advances casting fully and offers armored-caster abilities. That is the strongest numerical argument in its favor.

The remaining package does not fit. Aristeia is not documented as lawful, does not need armored melee progression, and would face substantial feat, proficiency, initiation, and organizational requirements. The Hellknights of the Godclaw are enemies tied to Demidius's childhood. This route would damage party identity for no unique arcane benefit.

Qualification: lawful alignment, medium armor, an armor-related feat, trained skills, third-level spells, and the order's initiation. **Source:** *Adventurer's Guide*, p. 92.

Genie Binder - F

Genie Binder offers binding and planar-servant abilities over five levels. A merchant-mage might find genie negotiation and elemental contacts narratively attractive.

The class requires a nongood alignment, while Aristeia is good-aligned, and advances casting on only three of five levels. Its entry also requires high-level summoning or binding capabilities and specialized feats. Two lost levels are far too expensive for a character already one level behind on Wizard casting.

Qualification: nongood alignment, specialized feats and skills, and planar ally, planar binding, or an equivalent high-level summoning ability. **Source:** *Elemental Master's Handbook*, p. 26.

Sentinel - F

Sentinel is a martial divine-obedience class with full base attack and no spellcasting progression. It rewards weapon use and direct combat.

Aristea's best offense comes from spells, sneak attack, metamagic, and control. The class advances none of those. Even a thematically perfect Nereus weapon package could not compensate for abandoning epic Wizard casting.

Qualification: deity-compatible alignment, Deific Obedience, Weapon Focus with the deity's favored weapon, and base attack +5.

Source: *Inner Sea Gods*, p. 202.

Confirmed Evangelist extension

Arcane Trickster ends at its printed tenth level. Aristeia does not take Arcane Trickster 11. Instead, Evangelist 2-10 treats Arcane Trickster as the aligned class and advances it nine times. The guide models those advancements as effective Arcane Trickster levels 11-19.

- Effective Arcane Trickster 12, 14, 16, and 18 continue the published even-level sneak-attack pattern.
- Casting advances on Evangelist 2-10, but not Evangelist 1.
- Surprise Spells is not gained a second time.
- Any extension of impromptu sneak attack or other non-sneak-attack features remains a separate table ruling.
- At character level 30, Aristeia has effective Wizard casting 28 and approximately +17d6 total sneak attack including the artifact.

Printed-rule prestige alternative

After Arcane Trickster 10:

1. **Levels 21-30: Loremaster 1-10.** Full casting and five secrets.
2. **Levels 31-35: Magaambyan Arcanist 1-5.** Full casting and selected druid-list expansion.

This ends with effective Wizard casting 34 but does not extend sneak attack after level 20. It is now inferior to the confirmed Evangelist route for Aristeia's established ray-striker identity, though it remains useful as a comparison build.

Feat and skill preparation

- Finish any remaining Arcane Trickster prerequisites naturally; do not divert before class level 10.
- For Magaambyan Arcanist, plan Scholar and Spell Mastery early and identify the exact druid spells before committing.
- For Loremaster, count existing metamagic and item-creation feats; Aristeia may already be close to the three-feat requirement.
- Preserve Knowledge (arcana), Knowledge (nature), Spellcraft, Disable Device, and the skills used for sailing, trade, or Nereus devotion.
- Treat Benthic Spell and Merciful Spell as engine feats. Confirm the order of damage conversion and the exact Sap Master eligibility rule in writing.
- Favor prestige classes with 10/10 casting. Aristeia already paid one caster level for Sorcerer 1 and should not casually pay another.

Source links

- Archives of Nethys: Arcane Trickster - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Arcane%20Trickster>
- Archives of Nethys: Stargazer - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Stargazer>
- Archives of Nethys: Magaambyan Arcanist - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Magaambyan%20Arcanist>
- Archives of Nethys: Loremaster - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Loremaster>
- Archives of Nethys: Cyphermage - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Cyphermage>
- Archives of Nethys: Harrower - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Harrower>
- Archives of Nethys: Veiled Illusionist - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Veiled%20Illusionist>
- Archives of Nethys: Pathfinder Savant - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Pathfinder%20Savant>
- Archives of Nethys: Bloatmage - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Bloatmage>
- Archives of Nethys: Evangelist - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Evangelist>
- Archives of Nethys: Enchanting Courtesan - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Enchanting%20Courtesan>
- Archives of Nethys: Mortal Usher - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Mortal%20Usher>
- Archives of Nethys: Eldritch Knight - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Eldritch%20Knight>
- Archives of Nethys: Dragon Disciple - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Dragon%20Disciple>
- Archives of Nethys: Arcane Archer - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Arcane%20Archer>
- Archives of Nethys: Sleepless Detective - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Sleepless%20Detective>
- Archives of Nethys: Master Spy - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Master%20Spy>
- Archives of Nethys: Mystic Theurge - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Mystic%20Theurge>
- Archives of Nethys: Hellknight Signifer - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Hellknight%20Signifer>
- Archives of Nethys: Genie Binder - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Genie%20Binder>
- Archives of Nethys: Sentinel - <https://www.aonprd.com/PrestigeClassesDisplay.aspx?ItemName=Sentinel>

Final verdict

Finish Arcane Trickster 10 at character level 20, then take Evangelist 1-10 with Arcane Trickster as the aligned class. This is not direct Arcane Trickster advancement: the base prestige class still stops at 10, while Evangelist extends it to effective Arcane Trickster 19. Return to Exploiter Wizard for levels 31-35. Stargazer is now the strongest alternative prestige class because patron adaptation makes its full-casting hex and star package legal, but it does not continue the sneak-attack engine as effectively as Evangelist.